

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7
 ♥ 10 7 6 4 2
 ♦ A 6 4 3
 ♣ 7

♠ A J 5
 ♥ K Q
 ♦ Q J 8
 ♣ 10 9 8 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 10 4 2
 ♥ 9 8 5
 ♦ 10 9 7
 ♣ A 4

♠ 6 3
 ♥ A J 3
 ♦ K 5 2
 ♣ K Q J 6 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1 ♣	1 ♠	3 ♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
while you still have the ♣A for an entry.

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S5 N:S3]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, West played the ♠7 and North the ♠5.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♦10, NOT another ♠.

You can see the ♠6, ♠5, ♠4, ♠3 and ♠2. So the ♠7 is West's lowest ♠, he is doing his best to discourage you from leading the suit again.

North held up with ♠A J x, hoping you would play the suit again and give him two tricks.

If you play the ♦10 West will win the ♦A and return a ♠, allowing you to drive out North's ♠A

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 7 5

♥ 10 7 6 4 2

♦ A 6 4 3

♣ 7

♠ A 9 8

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ 10 9 8 5 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S8 N:S3]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, East played the ♠7 and South the ♠8.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♠4.

You cannot see the ♠5. The most likely reason is that East has it, and his ♠7 is an encouraging signal. The only reason he would encourage you is if he held either the ♠A or ♠J.

Together, you two continue to play ♠s to drive out South's ♠A. When you get the lead with your ♣A you will cash your ♠ winners and East will still have the ♦A for some icing on the cake.

There IS another possibility if South is a better than average Declarer. East just might hold ♠ 9 7, giving South ♠ A J 8 5. South played the ♠8 as a falsecard to tempt you into playing the suit again. This isn't too likely, but if it happens just congratulate South for the fine play.